

Your First Hour with Claude.

A hands-on guide to getting set up, understanding what Claude can do, and building something useful before you leave this session.

What this is	A 30–45 minute guided session. You'll set up Claude, understand the basics, and walk away with s
What you need	A computer and a browser. That's it. We'll handle everything else together.
What you'll build	At least one real tool — a prompt, a template, or a shortcut — built specifically for your job.

What Is Claude, and Why Are We Using It?

Claude is an AI made by Anthropic. Think of it as a very fast, very well-read thinking partner — one that never gets tired, never judges you for asking a basic question, and can help with almost any kind of writing, thinking, or organizing work.

Most of us have used ChatGPT at some point. Claude is similar — it's a conversation-based AI — but it tends to be stronger at longer documents, nuanced writing, and following complex instructions. For the kind of work we do at RedPeg, it's the right tool.

Why now?

AI tools are not a trend we're watching from a distance. They are changing how fast good work gets done — and agencies that adopt them thoughtfully will outpace those that don't. This isn't about replacing anyone. It's about making the work you already do faster, sharper, and less draining.

The goal of this session is simple: by the time you leave, you will have used Claude to do something real for your actual job. Not a demo. Not a tutorial. Something you can use tomorrow.

How Claude compares to what you might already know:

	ChatGPT	Claude
Good for writing	✓	✓✓
Good for long docs	OK	Strong
Good for strategy / nuance	OK	Strong
Image generation	Yes (DALL-E)	No
Connects to your tools	Some	Yes (Slack, Gmail, Drive, Asana)
Custom team setups	Some	Yes (Skills, Projects)

Getting Set Up

Follow these steps now, with your computer open. This takes about 5 minutes.

1

Go to claude.ai

Open your browser and go to claude.ai. Click Sign Up. Use your work email — this keeps your work separate from personal use and makes it easier to share setups across the team.

2

Choose a plan

The free plan works fine to start. If you find yourself hitting limits, or want to use the Slack/Gmail/Drive connectors, the Pro plan (\$20/month) unlocks those. Ask Ryan if you're unsure which to use.

3

Set up your first Project

Think of Projects like a folder with memory. Claude remembers everything you tell it inside a Project — so you don't have to re-explain who you are or what account you're working on every time.

Click 'Projects' in the left sidebar and choose New Project. Name it something like 'My Work' or a specific client you work on most.

4

Tell Claude who you are

This is the most important setup step — and most people get it wrong. Don't type a sentence or two. Claude works best when it really knows you.

Here is how to do it right:

Go to the main Claude chat window (not your Project yet). Look for the microphone icon in the chat bar. Hit it — and just talk. Ramble. Don't be concise. Say your name, your role, your team, your clients, what you work on, what a typical week looks like, what drives you crazy, what you love doing, how you prefer to communicate. Spend 2-3 minutes just going. More is better.

When you stop, Claude will summarize what you said into a clean, organized profile. Copy that summary. Then go to your Project, open Project Instructions, and paste it in. Done. Claude now knows who you are — and will remember every time you come back.

If you would rather type than talk: same idea, just write freely. Stream of consciousness. Don't edit. Let it pour out. Claude will organize it for you.

5

Add the Onboarding Skill

Ryan will have given you a file called redpeg-ai-onboarding.skill. In your Project, click the upload or attachment icon and upload that file. Claude will recognize it automatically. Then just say: 'Let's get started.'

Understanding Claude — What You're Looking At

Claude has a few different modes. You don't need all of them — but knowing what exists helps you understand what to reach for.

Claude.ai Chat Your main home base.	This is where you'll spend most of your time. It's a conversation window. You type something, Claude responds. You can attach files, paste text, ask questions, ask it to write things, or just think out loud. There's no wrong way to use it.
Projects Memory for your work.	A Project is a folder where Claude remembers context between sessions. Set one up per client or per area of your work. Tell it the background once — who the client is, what you're working on, your preferences — and it carries that forward every time you open it. No more re-explaining.
Skills Specialist modes for specific work.	Skills are add-ons that teach Claude how to do a specific job — like reviewing a deck the way a CCO would, running a morning briefing, or ideating on a campaign brief. Ryan has built several for RedPeg. You add them to a Project and they activate automatically.
Connectors Claude talking to your other tools.	With a Pro account, Claude can connect to Slack, Gmail, Google Calendar, Google Drive, and Asana. That means you can ask things like 'What's on my calendar today?' or 'Find the last email from the Nike team' without leaving the Claude window.
Claude Code For developers and power users.	A command-line tool for people building more complex automations or doing technical work. Most RedPeg roles won't need this — but it's there if you get there.
Claude in Chrome Help while you browse.	A browser extension that lets Claude see the page you're looking at and help you in context. Useful if you're doing research, reading a long document online, or drafting a reply to an email in your browser.

Coming from ChatGPT? Here's What to Bring Over.

If you've been using ChatGPT — even just occasionally — you may have built up some useful context: how you like to be talked to, prompts that work well, instructions you've given it. Here's how to carry that over to Claude.

Your Custom Instructions

In ChatGPT, go to: Settings (bottom left) → Personalization → Custom Instructions.

Copy whatever is in those two boxes. Then open Claude and paste it with this message:

"Here's some context about who I am and how I like to work. Please keep this in mind." Save it in your Project Instructions.

Prompts That Worked

If you have prompts you've used over and over in ChatGPT — copy them into a note inside your Claude Project. They'll work in Claude too, usually even better. Don't start from scratch.

Your Chat History

ChatGPT lets you export your full history: Settings → Data Controls → Export Data. You'll get a file with all your old conversations. You don't need to import everything — but it's worth skimming for any context, persona instructions, or useful prompts you've built up.

What You Don't Need to Bring

Plugins, DALL-E images, and GPT-specific tools don't carry over. That's fine — Claude has its own connector ecosystem and Skills that cover most of what you'd need for your RedPeg work.

Skills, Connectors, and What Is Already Built

You do not have to build everything from scratch. Claude already has tools that connect to the software you use every day, and Ryan has built custom skills specifically for RedPeg work. Here is what is available right now.

Connectors — Claude talks to your tools

With a Pro account, you can connect Claude directly to the tools you already live in. That means instead of switching between apps, you just ask Claude — and it goes and gets what you need.

Asana	Ask Claude what tasks are assigned to you, what is overdue, or what is coming up this week. It can also create tasks for you. Example: 'Pull all my open Asana tasks on Nike and tell me what needs attention before Friday.'
Outlook / Email	Connect your Outlook inbox and Claude can scan it, summarize threads, flag urgent messages, and draft replies. This is the 600-email fix. Instead of drowning, you get a daily briefing: here is what matters, here are the drafts, approve what looks right.
Microsoft Teams	Ask Claude to find a message, summarize a channel conversation, or catch you up on what you missed. Useful after a day out of office or when a thread gets long.
Google Drive / SharePoint / iCloud	Point Claude at a document or folder. It can read files, summarize long docs, compare multiple versions, or pull specific information. Works across platforms — wherever your files actually live.
Google Calendar / Outlook Calendar	Ask Claude what is on your calendar today, find a good time for a meeting, or summarize what a busy week ahead looks like.

Built-in Claude Skills — no setup required

Claude has deep built-in capabilities that work out of the box. These are not add-ons — they are part of how Claude thinks. A few that are directly relevant to agency work:

Brand & Creative	Claude can research a brand, analyze its voice and positioning, write in its style, compare it to competitors, or help you build a creative brief from scratch. Give it a brand name and a goal — it knows how to think about this.
Finance & Contracts	Claude can read a scope of work, flag vague or risky language, help draft budget narratives, review a vendor contract for red flags, or build a simple cost tracker from a description. Not a lawyer or accountant — but a fast, smart first pass.
Research & Strategy	Paste any article, report, or web content and Claude will summarize, extract key points, or synthesize across multiple sources. Good for competitive research, category deep-dives, or building a strategic POV before a client presentation.
Writing & Editing	Claude matches tone, adjusts formality, shortens without losing meaning, rewrites for a different audience, and catches inconsistency. Give it a first draft and a direction — it works fast.
Data & Tables	Paste a spreadsheet, a list, or a block of raw information and Claude can organize it, build a comparison table, calculate totals, or restructure it for a presentation. Useful for vendor comparisons, budget summaries, or recap data.

RedPeg-Built Skills — custom for your work

Ryan has built skills specifically for how RedPeg operates. These get added to Claude like a file attachment — drop them in and they activate automatically.

redpeg-ideation	Brainstorm experiential campaign concepts. Give it a client, a category, and a goal — it generates activation ideas. Built for Creative, Strategy, and Account leads.
redpeg-morning-briefing	Pulls your Asana tasks, Slack overnight activity, and calendar to deliver a plain-language summary of your day before you've had coffee. Run it every morning.
cco-deck-review	Reviews any presentation the way a Chief Creative Officer would — story arc, persuasion, what is missing, what is off. Good before anything goes to a client.

session-handoff	When you have been working on something complex across multiple Claude sessions, this wraps up the conversation and creates a clean brief for the next one. No lost context.
redpeg-ai-onboarding	The skill powering this session. Once you are set up, you can run it again for any new team member.

What Claude Can Do — By Role

These are real things Claude can do right now — not hypothetical capabilities. Scan the section that matches your role and circle the ones that would actually help you.

Creative

- Generate 10 concept directions from a brief in under a minute
- Write copy deck drafts so you're reacting, not starting from nothing
- Translate vague client feedback into a clear creative direction
- Research a new brand category before a kickoff
- Turn creative review notes into a clean revision list
- Generate prompts for AI image tools from your concept description

Account Services

- Draft any client email from bullet notes in 30 seconds
- Summarize a long email thread so you're caught up fast
- Write post-event recaps with the right tone
- Build vendor comparison tables from pasted specs or quotes
- Draft scope of work language or change orders from a conversation
- Prep for a client call by turning notes into a smart agenda

Growth & Strategy

- Turn raw research into a clean strategic summary
- Draft the insight and 'so what' sections of a strategy deck
- Generate 5 different ways to frame the same recommendation
- Write competitive landscape overviews from brand descriptions
- Pressure-test a strategy by generating the smartest counterarguments
- Draft paid social copy or email marketing in multiple formats

Production / Coordination

- Turn an event brief into a day-of timeline or run-of-show
- Write vendor outreach or RFP emails for any production category
- Build a staffing tracker or talent briefing from a pasted schedule
- Convert run-of-show into a vendor task list
- Draft post-event production debrief notes from bullet points
- Create a checklist for any recurring production process

Admin / Operations

- Draft internal announcements or company-wide communications
- Summarize long documents into key bullets for leadership
- Write SOPs or process documentation from your verbal description
- Build tracking templates for any recurring process
- Translate HR or policy language into plain English
- Prep meeting agendas and talking points from a brief

How to Talk to Claude

The most common mistake people make with AI tools is being too vague — or being so vague they get a generic answer, decide it doesn't work, and give up. Here's the difference:

Think bigger than one email.

Most people start with: 'Help me write this email.' That is a fine place to start. But that is not where the power is. The power is when you stop thinking task by task and start thinking about the whole system.

Instead of this...

<i>What most people ask:</i> "Help me write this email."	<i>What you could ask instead:</i> "I have 600+ unread emails. Connect to my Outlook, scan everything from the last 2 weeks, flag anything urgent or from a client, summarize the threads I need to respond to, and draft responses for the top 5. I will review and approve before anything sends."
<i>What most people ask:</i> "Fix this one email."	<i>What you could ask instead:</i> "Set this up as a daily routine: every morning at 8am, scan my inbox, surface the 3-5 messages that actually need my attention, flag anything with a deadline, and have draft replies waiting for me when I open my laptop. I just approve or edit."
<i>What most people ask:</i> "Can you summarize this one doc?"	<i>What you could ask instead:</i> "Here are 8 vendor proposals for our Marriott activation. Read all of them. Build me a comparison table: price, deliverables, timeline, red flags. Then tell me which two you would shortlist and why."

What most people ask:

"Help me prep for this call."

What you could ask instead:

"I have a client check-in tomorrow on the Nike account. Pull everything: last 3 email threads, open Asana tasks, any notes I have pasted here. Give me a 1-page brief: where we stand, what they care about, what I should bring up, and what I should be ready to answer."

The simple formula:

Tell Claude: **what you want + who it is for + any constraints** (tone, length, format). The more specific you are, the better the first draft. And if the first draft is not right -- just say make it shorter or make it warmer and it adjusts.

Prompts you can use today:

- "Draft a [type of email] to [client/person] about [topic]. Keep it [tone]. Under [word count] words."
- "I need to write a recap of [event/meeting]. Here are my notes: [paste notes]. Turn this into a clean document."
- "I'm stuck on a headline for [campaign/project]. The brand is [brand], the audience is [audience]. Give me 8 directions."
- "Summarize this email thread and tell me what the 3 most important action items are: [paste thread]"
- "I have a client call tomorrow about [topic]. Help me prep — what questions should I ask and what should I be ready to answer?"

Your Onboarding Session — What to Expect

Once you've gone through Sections 01–06, open Claude, load the skill file Ryan gave you, and say: **"Let's get started."**

Claude will guide you through a short conversation — about 30–45 minutes total. It's going to ask you about your role, your day-to-day work, and what takes up most of your time. Answer honestly and specifically. The more you share, the more useful the output.

Getting to know you	<i>5–10 min</i>	Claude will ask about your role, your team, and what your week usually looks like. No trick questions.
Mapping your work to AI	<i>5–10 min</i>	Based on what you share, Claude will identify 2–3 specific places where it can help you — not vague capabilities, but real examples from your actual job.
A tour of what's already built	<i>5 min</i>	Claude will show you the RedPeg-specific skills, connectors, and setups that already exist — so you're not starting from zero.
Building something for you	<i>10–15 min</i>	This is the part that matters. Claude will help you build one real thing — a reusable prompt, a template, a shortcut — that's specific to your work. You leave with something, not just information.

After the session:

Use the thing you built this week. Just once. That's the only homework. When it works — and it will — come back and build the next one. That's how this becomes part of how you work.

Questions? Find Ryan or ask Claude directly: *"I'm new to this. Help me figure out where to start."*